Gala Lucia Gonzalez Barrios

Curriculum vitae · galalucia.com · linkedin.com/in/galalucia · Updated October 2026

Education

2023 – May 2027 (expected)
PhD, Individualized Interdisciplinary PhD Program (IIPD)
Virginia Tech
Dissertation on voice, identity and disability-led technology design after total laryngectomy; preliminary examination passed. Advisor, Dr. Ashley Shew. Committee includes Dr. Fabián Prieto-Ñañez (STS) and Dr. Vrushali Angadi (Communication Sciences and Disorders, Radford University). Graduate certificates in Human-Computer Interaction (Department of Computer Science) and Science, Technology & Engineering in Public Policy (STEP).

Sept – Dec 2025
Visiting Scholar, Institute for Innovation and Public Purpose (IIPP)
University College London
Hosted by Dr. Cecilia Rikap; political economy of AI, data concentration and voice technologies.

2021
Licenciatura in Electronic Arts
Universidad Nacional de Tres de Febrero (UNTREF), Buenos Aires
Thesis: *Novel Methods in the Intersection of Art, Science, and Technology from a Complexity Paradigm: The Case of Intercambios Transorgánicos.*

2017
Diploma in Transdisciplinary Integral Neurorehabilitation
Universidad del Museo Social Argentino (UMSA)

Art therapy
Primera Escuela Argentina de Arteterapia

Music
Colegio Juan Pedro Esnaola, Buenos Aires

Publications

2026
Re-voicing Identity: Care Ethics and the Politics of Unsilencing After Total Laryngectomy
G. L. **Gonzalez Barrios**
Proceedings of DRS2026, Design Research Society, Edinburgh. Paper.

2025
Singing without a Larynx: A Vowel-Based Real-Time Interface for Embodied Vocal Performance
G. L. **Gonzalez Barrios** and I. Bukvic
17th International Symposium on Computer Music Multidisciplinary Research (CMMR 2025), London. Paper.

2025

Evaluation of Preprocessing Pipelines in the Creation of In-the-Wild TTS Datasets

M. Di Bernardo, E. Misley, I. Correa, M. G. Iacovelli, S. Mellino and G. L. **Gonzalez Barrios**

arXiv preprint arXiv:2510.03111. Preprint.

2024

Reclaiming Digital Sovereignty: A Roadmap to Build a Digital Stack for People and the Planet

C. Rikap, C. Durand, E. Paraná, P. Gerbaudo and P. Marx, with contributing authors including G. L. **Gonzalez Barrios**

LUT University. Report, contributing author.

2021

Intercambios Transorgánicos: nuevos modos de producir conocimiento en el cruce entre «arte, ciencia y tecnología» desde el paradigma de la complejidad

G. L. **Gonzalez Barrios**

Universidad Nacional de Tres de Febrero. Tesis de licenciatura. In Spanish.

2021

Transdisciplina en Intercambios Transorgánicos

G. L. **Gonzalez Barrios**

2016

Prótesis electromecánicas no funcionales (PDF)

Intercambios Transorgánicos: G. Gonzalez (dir.), M. Aranda, N. Stavorengo, A. Las Peñas, J. M. Sesali Maydana, L. Escortell

8° Congreso Más allá del Humanismo / 8th Beyond Humanism Conference, Universidad Complutense de Madrid. In Spanish.

2015

Nuevas estrategias de resistencia y reinvención tecnológica frente al poder cibernético e informacional (PDF)

G. L. **Gonzalez Barrios**

2015

La función del arte en un modelo de neurorrehabilitación transdisciplinario (PDF)

G. L. **Gonzalez Barrios**

Research and creative projects

2025 – present

Singing Machine, lead researcher

Browser-based vocal instrument that lets people who have lost their larynx sing through mouth and hand movements captured by an ordinary webcam. Technical collaboration with Dr. Ivica Bukvic (Indiana University).

Ongoing	**Archivoz, director** Community-governed voice corpus and speech infrastructure responding to data extraction in speech synthesis. INARIA National AI Award, 2025.
2026 – 2027	**Returning Sound, collaborator** With Shout at Cancer (UK), the Education University of Hong Kong and ICAT (Virginia Tech); premiere at the Hong Kong Academy for Performing Arts, March 2027.
2024	**Shore Thing, co-creator** Board game on sea level rise and shorelines for classrooms; 2024 a2RU Emerging Creatives Challenge Grant, with Abby Tuckett (RISD); A2RU Annual Conference, Rochester Institute of Technology.
2019 – present	**Fonocosa, including Fonocosa Aldo and Fonocosa Furinge (2023)**
2017 – 2019	**C3D, lead designer** Digital-art tool for physical therapy focused on motivation and identity restoration; national awards in 2017 and 2018.

Awards, fellowships and funding

2025	**INARIA National Artificial Intelligence Award, Argentina** For Archivoz (project directed)
2025	**Labs for Liberation Summer Institute Fellow, disability and design** Selected from 300+ applicants.
2025	**Visiting Scholarship, UCL Institute for Innovation and Public Purpose**
2025	**CFWPP Future of Work Student Summer Research Grant** Virginia Tech (Singing Machine)
2024, 2025	**ICAT–ICTAS Grants** Virginia Tech, PD-L2Ork hackathons for HBCUs and MSIs
2024	**A2RU Grant for Transformative Cultural Change (team award)**
2023	**Full PhD Scholarship and Graduate Research Assistantship** Virginia Tech
2018	**From Science to Social Impact Award** National Ministry of Science and Technology (INVAP), Argentina
2017	**Metropolitan Fund of Arts, Culture and Science Award** Buenos Aires
2017	**Innovation in Critical Technology Research Award** UNTREF

Selected presentations

2026	**Re-voicing identity: Care ethics and the politics of unsilencing after total laryngectomy** DRS2026, Edinburgh, UK
2025	**Singing without a larynx: A vowel-based real-time interface for embodied vocal performance** CMMR 2025, London, UK
2025	**Invited seminar** UCL Interaction Centre (UCLIC), University College London, UK
2025	**Invited: Reconstituting Voice: Identity and Justice from Community Design** INIGEM Seminar Series, CONICET, Argentina
2025	**Invited: Ungovernable Soldiers of Utopia & The Anger that Liberates: Speculative Design and Relational Art** Conceptual Design Seminar, UNTREF, Argentina
2024	**Harmonizing Identities: A Conceptual Proposal for an Interdisciplinary Approach to Voice Restoration** Fall Voice Conference, Phoenix, AZ
2024	**Harmonizing Humanity: Developing an Interdisciplinary Approach to Voice Restoration Through Human-Centered Design** IIPPE Conference, Istanbul, Türkiye
2017 – 2019	**C3D: A Novel Tool for Physical Therapy Focused on Motivation and Identity Restoration Through Digital Art** Iberdiscap; INVAP; Metabody
2016	**Electromechanical Non-functional Prosthetics: Augmented Post-humanities** Friedrich Nietzsche International Conference, Universidad Complutense de Madrid, Spain
2016	**Foro Internacional Metabody, with Jaime del Val** Centros Culturales de España in Buenos Aires and Montevideo
2015	**Symposium ¿Descolonizando cuerpos? Cuerpo común y tecnologías plurales** Centro Cultural de España, Santiago de Chile
2015	**Round table, Ars Electronica Híbrido series** Centro Cultural Kirchner (CCK), Buenos Aires

Positions

2015 – present	**Director, Intercambios Transorgánicos** MUNTREF Centro de Arte y Ciencia (UNTREF), Buenos Aires Lead a transdisciplinary arts–science research program (projects include Archivoz and Fonocosa); supervised 40+ interdisciplinary students; facilitate international workshops on technology, art and social justice.

2023 – present	**Graduate Research Assistant** Virginia Tech
2021 – 2022	**Science & Technology Consultant, Tecnópolis** Ministry of Culture, Argentina Produced large-scale public science exhibitions for 50,000+ daily visitors; coordinated Argentina–China and Argentina–France cultural and scientific cooperation projects.
	Art therapist, transdisciplinary neurorehabilitation AlunCo, Buenos Aires

Exhibitions and performances

2023	**Premiere of *Territorio Prismático*, L2Ork fall concert** Virginia Tech and UNTREF (telematic)
2023	**Fonocosa Aldo and Fonocosa Furinge**
2022	***Transcontinental Grapevine*s, telematic laptop orchestra (co-director, with Ivica Ico Bukvic)** UNTREF and Virginia Tech
2021	***El espectro de la voz*, interactive installation with AudioStellar** Tecnópolis, BIENALSUR, Buenos Aires
2016	***Intercambios Transorgánicos*, exhibition** MUNTREF Arte y Ciencia, Tecnópolis, Buenos Aires
2016	**Installation and performance launching the C3D controller** Ciclo Delectro, Casa Temenos, Buenos Aires

Teaching and mentoring

2026	**Research Supervisor, Singing Machine** Virginia Tech Recruited (multi-round process, ~50 applicants) and supervise two undergraduate computer science research assistants.
2024, 2025	**Director, PD-L2Ork Hackathons for HBCUs and MSIs** Virginia Tech (ICAT–ICTAS funded) Designed and ran two consecutive annual hackathons to broaden participation from Historically Black Colleges and Universities and minority-serving institutions in the region.
Current	**Graduate School Application Mentor** Científico Latino
2015 – present	**Mentor and Instructor** UNTREF, Buenos Aires Mentor undergraduates in electronic arts, computer engineering and sound engineering toward interdisciplinary research careers; teach interactive systems and interface design.

Leadership and service

Current	**President, Latin American and Iberian Graduate Student Association (LAIGSA)** Virginia Tech
2024 – present	**Director, L2Ork International Community** Telematic performance network, Argentina–Mexico–USA.
	Member and Annual Summit Mentor Alliance for the Arts in Research Universities (A2RU)
	Member, PD-L2Ork Laptop Orchestra Virginia Tech
2022	**Organizer, First Young Researchers' Day** Department of Art and Culture, UNTREF

Skills

Research methods

Participatory and disability-led design, co-design workshops, photovoice, scoping reviews (Covidence, inter-rater reliability), qualitative analysis, policy analysis, human-subjects protocol design.

Technical

Python, JavaScript, Pure Data / PD-L2Ork / WebPd, MediaPipe, TensorFlow.js, speech audio preprocessing (voice activity detection, dereverberation evaluation), Arduino, Processing, 3D modeling and printing, Ableton Live.

Languages

Spanish (native), English (fluent).